

Deployment and Release Procedure

Nexora Labs · Department SOP · Infrastructure · Version 1.0

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1. Purpose

1.1 This procedure describes how changes reach production at Nexora Labs. It applies to the Infrastructure department and to any engineer releasing a service.

1.2 Where this procedure conflicts with the Information Security Policy (POL-INFOSEC-001), the Information Security Policy takes precedence.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

2.1 DevOps Engineer

2.1.1 The DevOps Engineer must hold a valid Production Access Certification before running a release.

2.1.2 The DevOps Engineer must verify that the pipeline security scan has passed before promoting a build.

2.1.3 The DevOps Engineer is required to publish a release note to the Delivery channel within one hour of a production release.

2.2 Backend Developer

2.2.1 The Backend Developer must ensure database migrations are backward compatible for at least one release cycle.

2.2.2 The Backend Developer must attach a rollback plan to any pull request that alters a database schema.

2.3 QA Engineer

2.3.1 The QA Engineer must sign off the regression suite before a release is promoted to production.

2.3.2 The QA Engineer is required to record defects found after release in the post-release defect log.

2.4 Project Manager

2.4.1 The Project Manager must confirm that the client has been notified of any release that changes a user-facing workflow.

3. Release Windows

3.1 Standard releases must be scheduled between 10:00 and 16:00 on a working day, so that the on-call engineer is available.

3.2 No production release shall take place on a Friday after 13:00, or on a public holiday, except under the emergency provision in section 5.

3.3 It is recommended that teams batch related changes into a single release rather than deploying several times in one afternoon.

4. Pre-Release Checklist

4.1 The release owner must confirm each of the following before promotion: the regression suite has passed, the security scan is clean, the rollback plan is attached, the change log entry is written, and the on-call engineer is aware.

4.2 A release must not proceed while any item in section 4.1 is outstanding.

5. Emergency Releases

5.1 An emergency release may bypass the scheduled window during a Severity 1 or Severity 2 incident.

5.2 An emergency release must still be approved by a second engineer, and the approval must be recorded in the incident ticket.

5.3 A post-incident review must be completed within five working days. The Escalation Procedure (SOP-ESCALATE-011) defines who attends.

6. Rollback

6.1 If error rates exceed two percent for five consecutive minutes after a release, the release must be rolled back before further investigation.

6.2 A rollback must be announced in the Delivery channel as it begins, not after it completes.